

▼ CAPTAIN'S WAISTCOAT AND BREECHES

Date 1774

Origin England

Material Wool, felt, brass, linen

Lined with white flannel for warmth, the waistcoat was worn with dress (on parade) and undress (on duty) uniform. The captain's regulation breeches were blue in the 1748 issue, but changed to white in 1774. Linen gusset and tapes at the rear were used to adjust the fitting.

The Royal Navy's fouled anchor motif on brass buttons

Button-back lapel

Hole made by musket ball

Gilt metal pommel and back-piece

Sword knot

Four orders of chivalry sewn onto the coat

Fouled anchor motif on buttons

Gold distinction lace

White silk twill lining

Lacing to adjust fit

WAISTCOAT

BREECHES

◀ VICE-ADMIRAL'S UNDRESS COAT

Date 1795

Origin England

Material Wool, silk, brass, gold alloy

This coat was worn by British Admiral Horatio Nelson at the Battle of Trafalgar on 21 October 1805. Because Nelson's right arm had been amputated in 1797, he wore the right sleeve pinned across his chest. The hole made by the musket ball that fatally wounded him is visible just beneath the left epaulette.

► LIEUTENANT'S SWORD AND SCABBARD

Date 1804

Origin UK

Length 71cm (28in)

The polished steel blade of this sword has been "blued" by being heated, and is decorated with gilt. It was presented to Lieutenant Robert Fowler, who was in service from 1793.

Four brass-covered horn buttons

Copper-gilt scabbard mounts

"Blued" blade